

Slow-Braised Lamb Shoulder

Seven hours in the oven, pulled apart with two forks. Built on a base of anchovies, garlic and rosemary — flavours that disappear into the meat and become something else entirely.

Ingredients

- 1 bone-in lamb shoulder (~2 kg)
- 6 anchovy fillets in oil
- 1 whole head of garlic, cloves separated and peeled
- 4 sprigs fresh rosemary
- 250 ml red wine
- 400 ml lamb or chicken stock
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- Salt and black pepper

Method

1. Preheat oven to 160°C (fan 140°C).
2. Score the lamb all over with a small knife. Push an anchovy fillet and a garlic clove into each cut.
3. Season generously with salt and pepper. Lay rosemary sprigs over the top.
4. Heat olive oil in a large flameproof casserole over high heat. Sear the lamb on all sides until deep brown, about 3 minutes per side.
5. Pour in the wine and let it bubble for 1 minute, then add the stock.
6. Cover tightly with a lid or foil. Transfer to the oven.
7. Braise for 6–7 hours until the meat falls away from the bone at the lightest touch.
8. Rest uncovered for 20 minutes before pulling. Reduce the braising liquid on the hob to make a sauce.